

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS



INDIA-UK - 01

MODULE - 46

- 1 British began trading relations with India through the East India Company in 1600 and soon set up factories in Surat and Madras.
- 2 India developed into one of the manufacturing hubs of the world by the 18th Century.
- 3 Soon British became interested in entering Indian politics to maximise their sources of revenue. This led to the British government replacing the East India Company in 1858.



- 4 Britain defended India from invasions from Persia, Afghanistan and other colonial powers
- 5 India protested against the exploitative British rule through several violent and non-violent methods.
- 6 This rule continued till 1947 till the Indian Independence Act transferred power to the dominions of India and Pakistan and freedom to the Princely States to decide its own fate



- 1 British rule in India led to the exploitation of the Indian economy particularly affecting the Indian handicraft industry.
- 2 The new Land revenue systems led to poverty and indebtedness
- 3 Commercialization of agriculture led to the problem of food security.
- 4 British's ad-hoc decisions on India's boundaries have led to border disputes with neighbouring countries China, Pakistan, Nepal and Bangladesh.



5 British policies have affected relations with neighbours like Sri Lanka in the post independent period.

6 Introduction of English language and Christian missionaries disturbed the social fabric of India. Positively this led to the rise of an educated Indian middle class and introduced new technologies and infrastructures like trains, telegraphs and steamships.

7 British also ended evils practices in the Indian society like Sati and Child marriage and legalized widow re-marriage in India.



1 After independence, India was granted Dominion status and continued to regard the British Monarch as the “Emperor of India”

2 In 1950, with the adoption of the Constitution, India became a sovereign independent republic and severed tutelage of the British

3 In the Cold War period, Britain was aligned with the US and one of the founding members of NATO

4 India, on the other hand, was non-aligned to any of the superpowers. It was one of the leading countries of Non-Aligned movement

5 Britain also supported Pakistan with military and economic aid including providing moral support to Pakistan in the Indo-Pak wars. This further affected India Britain relations.



POLITICAL

- 1 From a democratic system, Parliamentary form of government, Party system, Rule of Law to UK's bureaucratic structure and other rules and regulations, India is connected to the UK politically.
- 2 In 2004, India and the United Kingdom upgraded their bilateral relationship to that of Strategic Partnership.
- 3 In 2010, Prime Minister Cameron visited India and laid the foundations for Enhanced Partnership for the Future, defined by a high level economic and technological cooperation and close coordination on many regional and global issues.



POLITICAL

- 4 As Strategic Partners, India and UK increasingly seek to increase their **collaboration in foreign policy** and have a shared vision for peace, stability, democracy and prosperity.
- 5 Both sides have **institutionalised dialogues** in the areas of counter terrorism, cyber security, West Asia, Afghanistan, East Asia, UN and multilateral issues, disarmament and non -proliferation and consular and visa matters at Senior Official Level.



POLITICAL

PARLIAMENTARY EXCHANGES

1 The Parliaments of India and the UK have close relations. There is an All-Party Parliamentary Group on India in the UK Parliament. Parliamentary exchanges have also taken place under Commonwealth Parliamentary Association.

2 The Speaker of Lok Sabha, Smt. Meira Kumar, visited UK from 17 – 19 January 2011. The regular exchanges between the Members of Parliament of two countries helped in strengthening cooperation between the fourth pillar of democracy between the two countries.



POLITICAL

2010 PM VISIT TO INDIA

- 1 During the visit of UK PM to India in 2010 PM remarked that 'India is valued by world not only because it is rising power but it is a responsible global power'.
- 2 Both countries expressed interest to initiate negotiations on civil nuclear cooperation and cooperate in cyber security.
- 3 UK endorsed India's bid to permanent membership in UNSC, enhanced role in International bodies and early membership in International export control regimes to counter the global challenges.



POLITICAL

OUTCOME OF RECENT VISIT

- 1 During the visit Statue of Lord Basaveshwara who worked for gender equality and democratic values in 12th century was unveiled by PM Modi.
- 2 3 outcome documents on energy and climate change, defence and security, development partnership was announced. Both sides collaborated to set up fast track forums for investment and also agreed to float rupee denominated bond from London
- 3 Civil Nuclear Cooperation Agreement signed in 2010 and paved way for further cooperation.



POLITICAL

OUTCOME OF RECENT VISIT

- 4 PM Modi announced direct AI flight connecting London and Ahmedabad.
- 5 To help NRIs, PM Modi created Indian community welfare fund and 'Madad' online platform to sort out visa and OCI related issues and also assured to simplify overseas citizenship of India and PIO merger scheme
- 6 UK expressed interest to aid India to developing 3 smart cities Amaravati, Indore and Pune



POLITICAL

HIGH-LEVEL VISITS

- 1 There has been number of high-level visits exchanged between the two sides
- 2 The recent ones being the visit of Prime Minister David Cameron in February and in November 2013 and visit of External Affairs Minister of India in March 2014.



POLITICAL

PM'S VISIT TO UK IN NOVEMBER 2015

- 1 Prime Minister Narendra Modi's visit to UK from 12-14 November, 2015 took the relationship between the largest democracy and the oldest democracy to new heights.
- 2 During the visit, the two Prime Ministers endorsed a Vision Statement setting out the fundamental principles on which UK-India partnership is built and outlined a roadmap for deepening cooperation and agreed on a new Defence and International Security Partnership aimed to intensify cooperation on defence and security, including cyber security, counter-terrorism and maritime security.
- 3 They also endorsed a Joint Statement on Energy and Climate Change.



POLITICAL

UK PM'S VISIT TO INDIA

- In November 2016, UK PM May visited India on her **first overseas bilateral visit outside Europe**. This reflected the continued importance that UK attaches to its bilateral relationship with India.
- India and UK signed agreements during the visit-

- 1 MoU on Cooperation in Ease of Doing business, MoU on Cooperation in the field of Intellectual property rights and business contracts worth £1.2 billion between British and Indian companies were concluded



POLITICAL

INDIAN PM'S VISIT TO UK

- In April 2018, during the Commonwealth Heads of Government meeting in London, PM Modi and PM Theresa May, held a meeting.

- 1 During the visit, it was decided to launch an India-UK Tech Alliance between NASSCOM and Tech UK, establish a UK-India Tech hub, develop UK-India Tech Cluster partnerships, an Advanced Manufacturing Centre in India and collaborate in Artificial Intelligence and Digital Healthcare in India's Aspirational Health Districts Programme.



POLITICAL

INDIAN PM'S VISIT TO UK

- 2 They also announced new India-UK Dialogues on Investment and Fin-Tech, a multilateral India-UK Trade Dialogue and sector-based roadmap to address barriers to trade.
- 3 Ten MOUs/agreements were signed during the visit covering areas such as
 - Strategic- cyber-relationship framework, safe nuclear energy use, sharing of criminal records
 - Agriculture and Allied Sectors- cooperation in animal husbandry, fisheries and dairying, on rejuvenation of river Ganga
 - Capacity Building- Skill Development, vocational education, research in humanities and social sciences under the Newton-Bhabha programme and setting up of a centre of excellence in Ayurveda and traditional Indian medicine



Newton-Bhabha
Fund

INSTITUTIONALISED DIALOGUES

India and UK have a number of **bilateral dialogue mechanisms** The important ones are-

- 1 Economic and Financial Dialogue at Finance Minister-level.
- 2 Joint Economic & Trade Committee at Commerce Minister-level.
- 3 Strategic Dialogue at NSA-level.
- 4 Foreign Office Consultations at Foreign Secretary-level.
- 5 Home Secretary-level Dialogue.
- 6 Defence Consultative Group at Defence Secretary-level.
- 7 Cyber Dialogue and Counter-Terrorism Dialogue.



DEFENCE

- 1 During Prime Minister's visit to UK in November 2015, the two countries agreed to elevate their Defence relationship by establishing capability partnerships in strategic areas.
- 2 India and the UK have active defence cooperation with dialogue at Defence Secretary and three services level.
- 3 At the services level, joint exercises and wide ranging exchanges between the three services are conducted on the basis of mutually agreed agenda.
- 4 Both sides have emphasized the need to look at joint production and joint research rather than just sales and the need to move beyond a buyer-seller relationship.
- 5 In February, 2014 the India-UK Defence Consultative Group Meeting at the level of Defence Secretary was held in New Delhi.



DEFENCE

6 In 2015, PM Modi visited Britain and signed a Defence and International Security Pact for curbing security concerns.

7 Maritime security especially in the Indian Ocean is an important area of cooperation in the security and defence cooperation between the two countries.

8 The Indian and UK armed forces share historical ties and regimental links, have a similar ethos and train well together on a rotational basis.

The joint army-to-army Ajeya Warrior biennial exercises have been held since 2005 at battalion-level strength



DEFENCE

9 Although India is the world's second-largest arms importer, the acquisition of arms from the UK remains limited, focusing largely on 123 Hawk Advanced Jet Trainer (AJT) aircraft from the UK's largest defence company BAE Systems from 2008

10 India seeks advanced technology and local manufacturing through its Make in India policy in defence.

11 In this regard, it has established two defence industrial corridors in Tamil Nadu and Uttar Pradesh and revised the defence procurement procedure in November 2019 to encourage foreign direct investment in defence.

12 The future lies in the delivery of defence technologies through bilateral collaborative program, with an increased focus on defence industrial collaboration.



DEFENCE

13 Bilateral defence and security equipment talks in April 2019 led to the strengthening of the Defence Equipment Cooperation Memorandum of Understanding (DEC MOU) of 2007 to identify mutual defence and security capability needs and collaborate on issues to support long-term defence cooperation.



14 "The 2021 version of our bilateral Navy exercise (Konkan 21) could be the most complex and sophisticated yet," British High Commissioner Sir Dominic Asquith said.



DEFENCE

- 15 Ex-Konkan is a bilateral naval exercise and the cornerstone of India's maritime cooperation..
- 16 It is designed to test the ability of the two Commonwealth navies to operate side-by-side during the war and other operations.
- 17 The UK has been a preferred port of call whenever Indian Navy operates in the northern Atlantic.
- 18 On May 22, 2017, the Indian mission in the UK organized the first community-wide anti-terrorism pledge taken by Indian embassies and missions around the world.



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